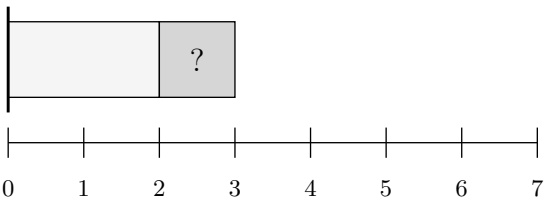
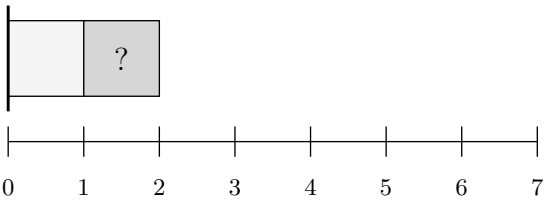
A hidden end can be anywhere in its gray band, including the edges. Each trial may use new lengths. Join strips end to end from 0, with no gap or overlap.

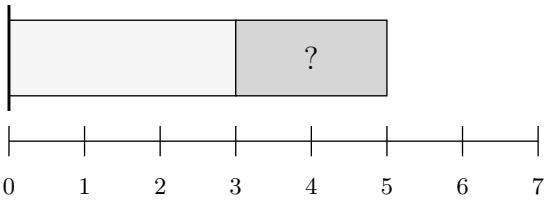
A: 2 to 3 units



B: 1 to 2 units



A + B: 3 to 5 units





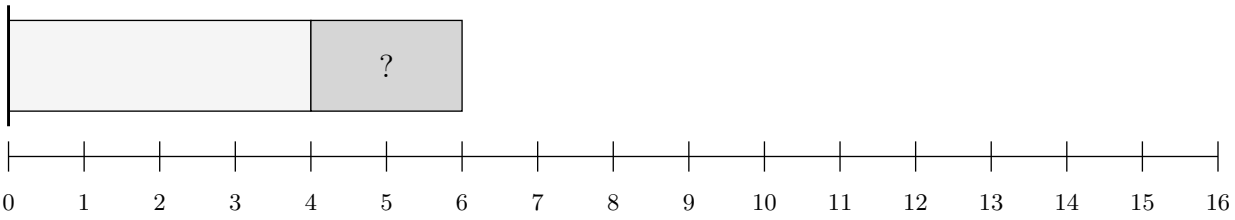
3



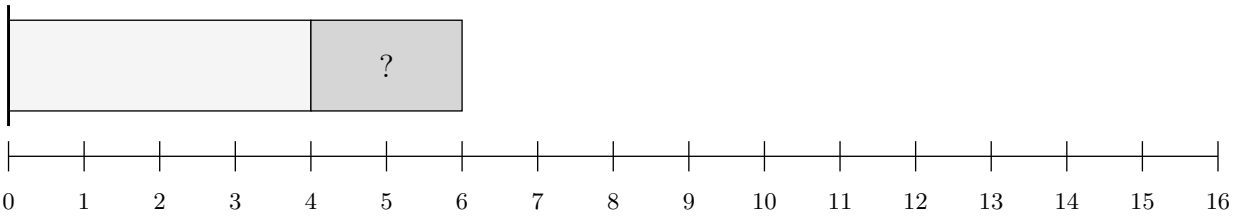
5

Problem 5: Compare the gaps between the right ends of these joins, starting at 0. Repeated A means the same unchanged length; B may vary separately. Find the tightest range for each gap.

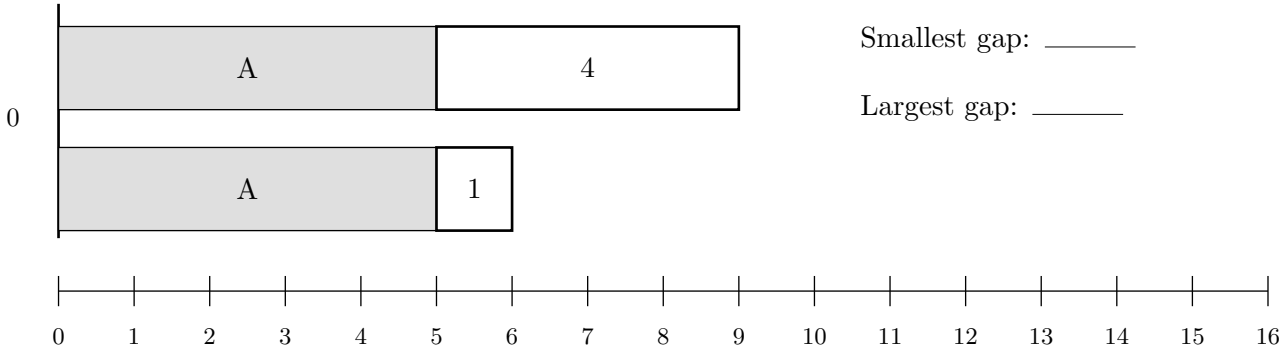
A: 4 to 6 units



B: 4 to 6 units

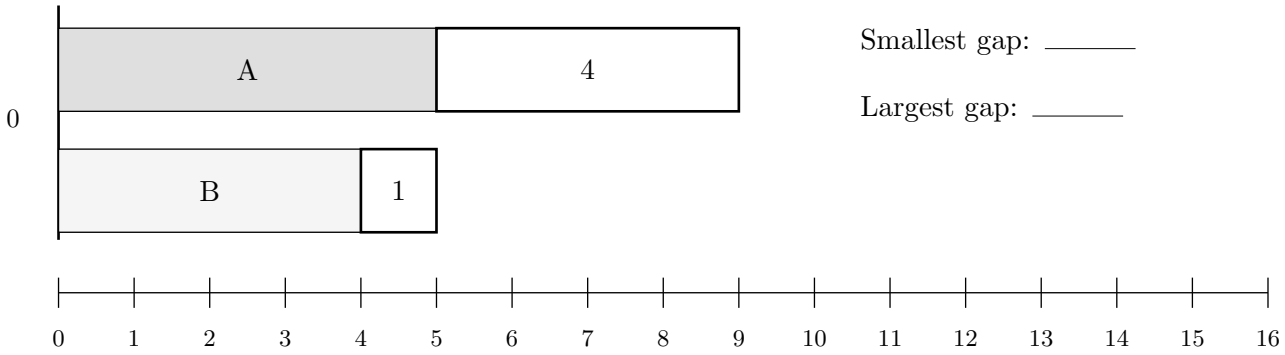


One possible setting; the white pieces are exactly 4 and 1 units long.



Smallest gap: _____

Largest gap: _____

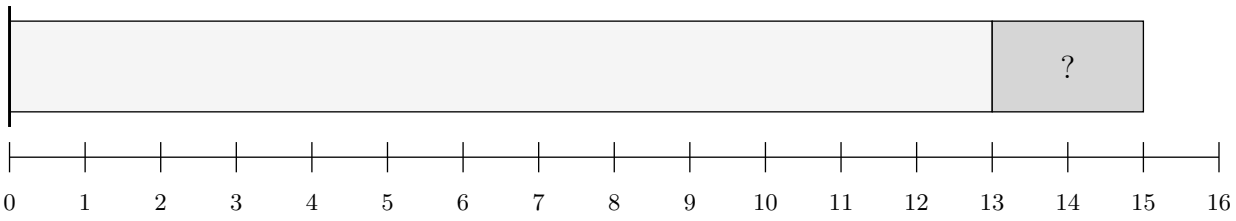


Smallest gap: _____

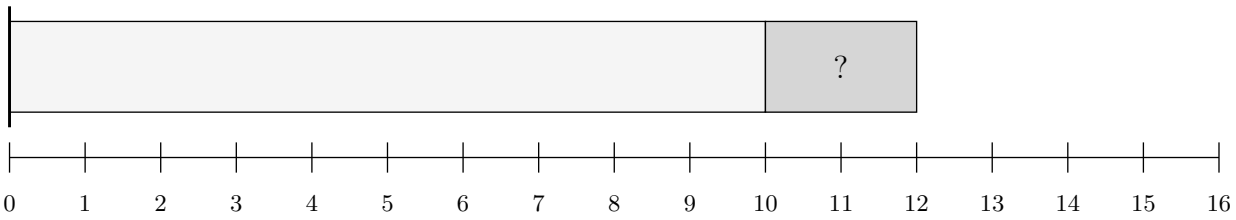
Largest gap: _____

Problem 6: Align both starts at 0. Find the tightest guaranteed range for the gap between the ends. Build lengths that show neither bound can be improved.

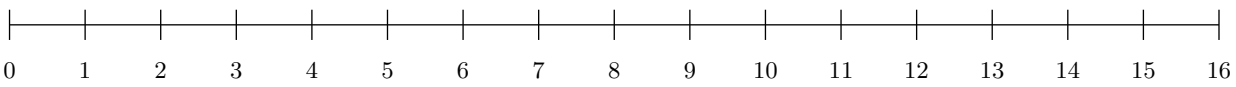
long strip: 13 to 15 units



short strip: 10 to 12 units

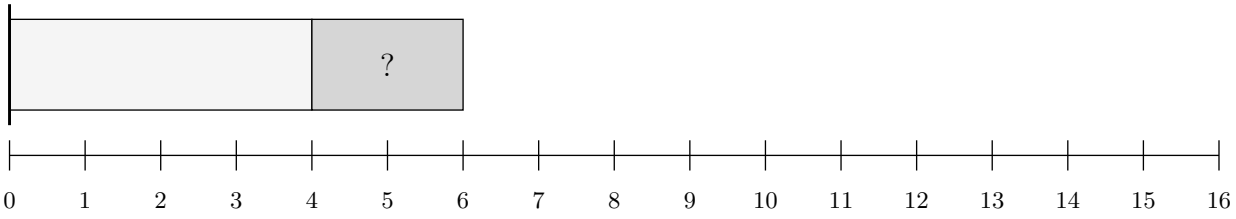


Problem 7: Someone subtracts the two middle values and announces one exact gap. Can you choose allowed strips that show why this is unsafe?



Problem 8: A and B must fill 9 units exactly. Find every pair of whole-unit lengths that fits both cards.

A: 4 to 6 units



B: 3 to 5 units

